



warriors renowned for their physicality.

On the other hand, three-time PKL champion Patna Pirates and season two champion U Mumba have refrained from acquiring marquee names for their respective rosters.

Telugu Titans is aiming to break its cycle of underperformance this season under new head coach Krishan Kumar Hooda, who earlier led Dabang Delhi to the PKL summit in season eight.

Ram Maher Singh's Gujarat Giants has snagged PKL 10 standout Guman Singh. The 25-year-old all-rounder will be a key cog in its attacking machine alongside Parteek Dahiya and Rakesh.

Changing of the guard

The league has undergone a significant transformation ahead of this season. The game, now a whirlwind of speed and physicality, has demanded a youth movement, ushering out the legends who once defined it.

Rahul Chaudhari, the original showman of PKL, whose stardom ascended alongside the league's, was a casualty of this seismic shift. His unsold status, though anticipated, marked the end of an era. Like other veterans — Deepak Niwas Hooda, Nitin Tomar, Surender Nada, and Vishal Bhardwaj — Chaudhari's glory days have dwindled. Kabaddi, it seems, is entering a new age, where

Winning combination: Defending champion Puneri Paltan have retained a strong core of players from their title-winning squad. Pics: PKL

legacy alone is no longer a passport to continued success.

The torch has been passed. The old guard has made way for the next generation as all 12 teams exceeded the mandatory quotas of the NYP (New Young Players) programme. Scouts roamed local tournaments in search of future stars. Raiders and defenders alike were the targets of relentless pursuits, as teams spared no expense in securing the next set of superstars.